

Appendix A:

First Client Interview

Date: 22.05.2024

Location: at our school

Participants:

- Madalena Rebelo de Sousa (Manager, Students for Students)
- Luisa Rebelo de Sousa (Co-administrator, Students for Students)
- [***](Co-administrator, Students for Students)

Before I had the interview, I met with Madalena on Zoom so she could explain in detail their current management system on Sunday (19.05).

Me: Hello Madalena, Luisa, and [***] before we begin the interview I wanted to ask you if you are okay with being recorded for my IA.

Madalena: I am fine with that

Luisa: I don't mind either

[*]:** Will you send this audio to anyone else?

Me: No, it is just so I can transcribe it later as an interview. I won't use your voice, but if you want to then I can anonymize your name when I write it.

[*]:** Thank you.

Me: Ok, so what do you think are the main challenges you face with the current system for managing the students and tutors?

Madalena: As I told you on Sunday, I don't have the time for manual matching anymore because I'm doing full IB. Not only that, but we now have more students and tutors. Sometimes, when I don't have the time to match them up, I get angry emails from either the parents or the students who have been waiting for so long.

Luisa: Also, we don't have a good measuring system for tutor performance. Even though it's not necessarily our fault, we want to guarantee quality because that's one of our main goals. We'd really like to maybe include some type of a rating system so we can reward the good tutors and

make sure students get matched with the best ones. We can discuss possible issues with low-ranked tutors and maybe even remove them.

Me: Ok I think I might be able to create like a basic 5-star rating system for that. Is there anything else you want to change about the current system, [***]?

[*]:** Right now, in the beginning, it was still manageable that all the student and tutor information were spread out across different Google Sheets, but now we have so many tutors and student requests that it is really tough to maintain an overview. We were actually thinking about getting more admins to manage the system, but it is already tough to coordinate.

Me: I could try and create some type of a centralized data system with information divided based on the subjects.

[*]:** That sounds good

Luisa: Also whatever the idea is, the data has to be secure even if the admin doesn't have access as long as Madalena has access, it is fine. Some student share their grades and we aren't allowed to let anyone see it.

Madalena: But however great your new thing is we can't pay for any software subscriptions or anything like that since we are a non-profit.

Me: Ok, so I wrote everything down. Are you free to meet again tomorrow so I can ask you for feedback about my ideas?

Meeting Two: Feedback on Proposed Criteria

Date: 23.05.2024

Participants:

- Madalena Rebelo de Sousa (Manager, Students for Students)
- [***] (Co-administrator, Students for Students)

Discussion:

Me: Hi Madalena and [***], thanks again for meeting with me today. I made a list of possible features.

*I show them a list of a few proposed features and a basic GUI sketch

Me: So, here are some initial ideas I've come up with. What do you guys think?

Madalena: I think these are good.

[***]: I agree, but are you sure about the algorithm?

Me: I will just recommend it based on days and preferences, but in the end, you are the ones that decide the final matchups.

[***]: Ok, if that works that would save Madalena a lot of work

*I present sketches of possible frames and they ask questions about some features.

[***]: I think, this looks really nice! Now we don't need to color code the tutors and students anymore.

Madalena: I agree if we can use this it would save us a lot of time.

Me: I'm happy that you both like the initial designs, but just so you know they are just ideas I don't know how everything will work out in the end.

Final Meeting: Feedback on Final Product

Date: 26.02.2025

Participants:

- Madalena Rebelo de Sousa (Manager, Students for Students)

Me: Hi Madalena, I know that we have had many calls while creating this App, but I wanted to have a formal interview in order to see how you like the final project. I know you have basketball practice, so thank you for taking the time to meet.

Madalena: Of course! Thank you for offering to create the App. I didn't really think of this as an option, but I think this will make things much faster. After you sent me that App I tried a few things and checked all the features. I think it's really great.

Me: Did you see the list of features I gave and did you have time to score them?

Madalena: Yeah I did.

*Hands me a piece of paper with the following scoring:

Criteria	Luisa's Score	Madalena's Score	Comments
Is able to authenticate app users Matches students correctly with suitable tutors using a compatibility algorithm	9	9	Works as intended, but it is restricted to 3 students. Even though the best almost always falls within the three it would be helpful to have the ability to scroll
Reduces the time my client takes to match students with tutors to under 1,5 min	9	10	Works as intended, but sometimes typos in student ID, etc can delay the process
Updates Google Sheets with unique matchup ID once students get matched up with a tutor	10	10	Works as intended
Displays a list of all current unmatched students that can be matched	9	9	Good, but the formatting could be a bit more user-friendly and perhaps able to expand when clicked on.
Displays lists of all current matched tutors, matched students, and unmatched tutors	9	9	Same as above
Has an easily navigable graphical user interface (based on client feedback)	7	9	The design is a bit simplistic, but it allows for a clear understanding of the features. The App could be a bit more pleasing.
Can send bulk emails to all tutors or students	8	8	Could have more templates instead of just a meeting reminder.

Me: Do you have any other suggestion? Even small ones that could help you in the future?

Madalena: Instead of having to search for the student and tutor individually, it would be nice to have a feature where you can search by the matchup ID, and the information for both the tutor and student appears on the same page. Luisa found the idea great as well.

Me: Like an additional screen?

Madalena: Yeah and also, instead of writing each email manually, having different templates could help us as well. Currently, when we write in Gmail we use that feature a lot. For example, when scheduling an interview, sending feedback forms, calling meetings, or reminding them of tasks all we need to do is fill out the names.

Me: Ok. Another suggestion I have is that if there are critical changes or if unmatched students have not been matched for more than 48 hours, the admin could be notified.

Madalena: That sounds really helpful cause I sometimes forget to check and we have received angry emails.

Me: Finally, I have a small suggestion if you would like. Instead of storing the password as plain text in the spreadsheet, it could be encrypted using a unique method only known to you. Like moving each letter up by two letters when you store it and it could be changed back when you read it. For example, if you write CDE in the spreadsheet it takes the value as ABC in the App.

Madalena: It sounds like a good improvement. But I think I'll first test out the current system for a few months and then we could maybe have another meeting and you could make some changes.

Me: Sure! Thanks for the feedback, Madalena.